

Budget — AWS Agentic AI Spring 2026 (Amazon Research Awards)

Project: Multi-Agent Provenance-Aware Retrieval for Trustworthy Software Engineering AI

PI: Chris Brown · Student Researcher: Jason Cusati · Virginia Tech

Period of Performance: Aug 1, 2026 – Jul 31, 2027 (12 months)

DRAFT — pending PI sign-off

Cash Gift Budget — USD \$70,000 total

Amazon Research Awards are structured as a one-time unrestricted gift to the institution. **Per the ARA Program Rules, awards may not be used for indirect (F&A) costs.** AWS Promotional Credits are allocated separately, below.

Line item	Amount
Cusati GRA stipend (12 mo, 100% effort academic + summer)	\$30,000
Cusati GRA tuition remission (2 semesters, in-state)	\$24,000
Cusati GRA fringe / benefits	\$6,000
Conference travel (1 agentic-AI venue + Amazon visit)	\$5,000
Equipment (workstation upgrade + accelerator)	\$5,000
Total cash gift	\$70,000

Justification. The cash budget concentrates on a single doctoral student (Cusati) at 100% effort across 12 months, matching ARA budget guidance (“one to two graduate students ... for one year, plus some conference travel and equipment”). Mr. Cusati owns the Bedrock implementation, the evaluation harness, and the knowledge-accumulation case study. Travel funds support dissemination of the open-source release; equipment supports local development of agent topologies before deployment to AWS. No PI summer-salary line is included; Dr. Brown supervises the project as part of his ongoing faculty effort.

AWS Promotional Credits — USD \$50,000 (separately budgeted)

The CFP allocates AWS Promotional Credits as a complement to the cash gift. Allocation reflects the AWS-native architecture described in the proposal:

Service	Alloc.	Use
Bedrock Agents (Multi-Agent Collab.)	\$20,000	Supervisor + specialist agent run-time
Bedrock KB (hybrid search + reranking)	\$5,000	Retrieval over SE corpora
Neptune Analytics (via Bedrock KB)	\$10,000	KG layer storage + queries
SageMaker FT (stretch goal)	\$10,000	Provenance-routing model
Misc Bedrock (multimodal, action groups)	\$5,000	Validation tool invocations
Total AWS credits	\$50,000	

Justification. Bedrock Agents and Bedrock Knowledge Bases together account for half of credits and run year-round during system development and evaluation. Neptune Analytics funds the managed graph backend underlying the KG layer. SageMaker fine-tuning is a Year-1 stretch goal and may be deferred or reallocated to additional Bedrock inference capacity if empirical workload requires.

Combined award: \$70,000 cash + \$50,000 AWS credits = **\$120,000.**

Notes: (1) Dollar amounts are draft estimates pending PI sign-off; tuition remission rates follow VT in-state graduate published rates for AY 2026–27. (2) F&A is zero per ARA Program Rules (one-time unrestricted gift; no indirect costs). (3) AWS credits are subject to the AWS Promotional Credit T&C and AWS Customer Agreement, which take precedence over ARA Rules in case of conflict. (4) Travel and equipment lines are conservative; unspent residual will be redirected to extending Mr. Cusati’s appointment.